

Project Overview:

A Local Educational Nonprofit (LEN) sought to expand its services into a neighboring county and wanted to identify the most effective recruitment strategy. This project analyzes historical recruitment data to compare outreach channels, evaluate conversion rates and cost-effectiveness, and recommend a data-driven approach for successful expansion. Organization-specific details have been anonymized to protect client confidentiality.

Bullitt County Expansion Recommendation

Executive Summary

As a local educational nonprofit (LEN) considers expansion into the counties surrounding Louisville, Bullitt County represents a promising opportunity for targeted recruitment. Public demographic and educational data indicate a meaningful need for academic support among Bullitt County students, although logistical factors may create barriers to access, follow-up, and program participation.

The recruitment dataset suggests that parent referrals and school- and library-based outreach are among the most effective strategies for moving prospective scholars through the recruitment process. In contrast, Bullitt County online advertisements generated high initial interest but had the lowest parent-contact-to-match conversion rate and the highest cost per match of all recruitment channels. The Parent referral campaign, meanwhile, had the highest conversion rate and lowest cost per match.

Scholar Recruitment by Source and Funnel Stage

Source	Parent Contact → Apps	Apps → Eligible 5-8	Eligible 5-8 → Completed Intake	Completed Intake → Matched
W. Louisville school fair	24.5%	81.3%	79.5%	77.4%
S. Louisville library/community	25.4%	77.4%	75.0%	72.2%
Okolona youth sports table	20.7%	72.2%	69.2%	66.7%
Jeffersontown school night	27.0%	80.0%	68.8%	72.7%
Bullitt online ads	12.9%	81.5%	50.0%	45.5%
Bullitt library table	23.4%	80.0%	66.7%	50.0%
Bullitt parks event	18.5%	76.5%	53.8%	42.9%
Parent referral campaign	33.9%	89.5%	82.4%	78.6%

Based on these findings, LEN should continue investing recruitment resources in Bullitt County while shifting capacity away from online advertising and toward referral-based and school- and library-based outreach, while further investigating the causes of the significant early-stage attrition among families reached through online ads.

Key Metrics Overview

1. The Parent referral campaign had the highest parent-contact-to-match conversion rate and the lowest cost per match of all recruitment sources.
2. The recruitment channels tested in Bullitt County had lower overall recruitment success than those tested in Jefferson County.
3. A similar pattern emerged in both Bullitt and Jefferson counties: school- and library-based outreach had higher parent-contact-to-match conversion rates than sports- and parks-based outreach.
4. Bullitt County online ads had the highest cost per match of all recruitment sources at \$260 per matched scholar.
5. All recruitment sources experienced attrition across the recruitment funnel, but the Parent referral campaign and W. Louisville school fair produced the strongest overall funnel outcomes.

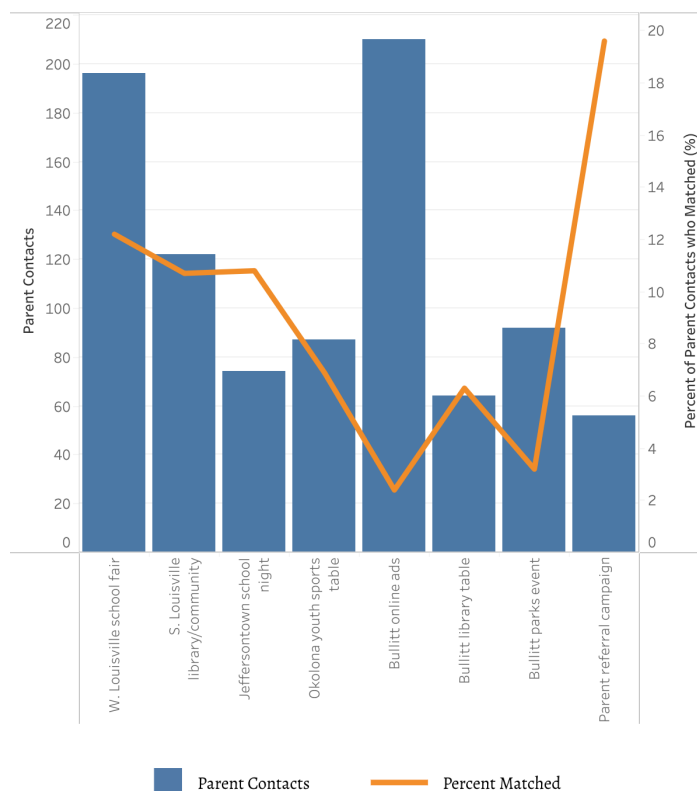
Analysis of Recruitment Performance

The Parent referral campaign performed exceptionally well at moving prospective scholars through the recruitment funnel. Of all parent contacts generated through the campaign, 19.6% ultimately resulted in a matched scholar - the highest contact-to-match conversion rate of any recruitment channel.

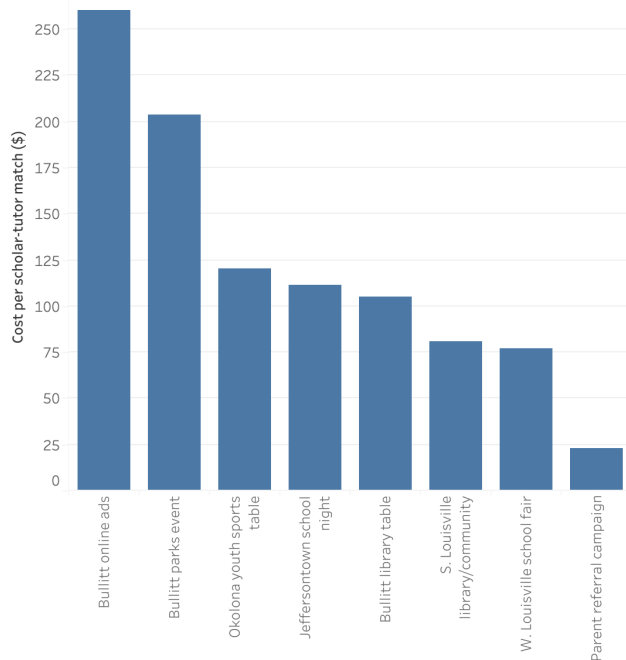
In contrast, Bullitt County online ads had the lowest contact-to-match conversion rate at just 2.4%, despite generating the highest number of parent contacts (210).

This contrast suggests that high levels of initial interest do not necessarily translate to completed matches. LEN should therefore prioritize recruitment methods that more effectively reach and retain families throughout the recruitment process.

Parent Contacts vs. Percent of Matches



Cost Per Scholar-Tutor Match



The Parent referral campaign matched 11 scholars at a cost of \$22.73 per match, making it the most cost-effective recruitment source. The next most cost-effective source, W. Louisville school fair events, cost \$77.08 per match—more than three times the cost per match of the Parent referral campaign.

Bullitt County online ads had the highest cost per match of any recruitment source. At \$260 per matched scholar, the channel cost more than eleven times the amount of the Parent referral campaign. These results suggest an opportunity to redirect resources toward more cost-effective recruitment strategies.

The dataset provides outcomes for three recruitment channels targeting Bullitt County, four targeting Jefferson County, and a Parent referral campaign whose geographic target is not specified. Across the four Jefferson County recruitment channels, 10.6% of parent contacts ultimately resulted in matched scholars. In comparison, the three Bullitt County channels had a combined parent-contact-to-match conversion rate of just 3.3%.

The chart below compares family retention across each stage of the recruitment funnel. Lighter shading indicates lower stage-to-stage retention, while darker shading indicates higher retention.

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Across all recruitment sources, the greatest attrition occurs between parent contact and application. The four Jefferson County channels also show stronger retention overall than the three Bullitt County channels, particularly in the later stages of the recruitment funnel. This suggests that, within the channels represented in this dataset, prospective Bullitt County families were less likely to progress through the recruitment process than families reached through Jefferson County channels.

Among the four Jefferson County channels, the W. Louisville school fair events demonstrated the strongest overall funnel retention, while the Bullitt library table demonstrated the strongest retention among the three Bullitt County channels. The channels with the weakest retention in Jefferson County and Bullitt County were

the Okolona youth sports table and the Bullitt parks event, respectively. This pattern suggests that school- and library-based outreach was more effective at moving families through the recruitment funnel than sports- and parks-based outreach.

The Parent referral campaign demonstrated the strongest retention throughout the recruitment funnel, achieving the highest stage-to-stage retention rate at every transition. W. Louisville school fair events also maintained consistently strong retention across funnel stages.

Research Findings

Bullitt County presents a meaningful need for academic support, but families may face logistical barriers to program participation.

Public data suggest a continued need for academic support among Bullitt County middle school students. Bullitt County Public Schools reports that 40% of middle school students scored proficient or distinguished in reading on the Kentucky Summative Assessment, while 34% scored proficient or distinguished in mathematics.¹

The average commute to work for Bullitt County residents is 28.7 minutes, approximately 20% longer than the Kentucky average.² While commute time does not directly explain the higher attrition observed in LEN's Bullitt County recruitment channels, it raises questions about whether convenience, program location, and follow-up burden may affect families' ability to complete the recruitment process.

Bullitt County schools have an existing family-support infrastructure aligned with LEN's target population.

The district's 12 elementary schools and 6 middle schools are supported by Family Resource Centers (FRCs) and Youth Services Centers (YSCs), which connect families with resources addressing barriers to student success.³ Families already turn to these centers for assistance accessing food, clothing, utility support, and health and mental health services.

FRCs and YSCs provide an existing communication network for reaching parents/guardians of school-aged children. This is particularly relevant to LEN's recruitment model, in which parents and guardians play a central role in determining whether a student enters and progresses through the recruitment process.

Bullitt County has multiple existing community touchpoints where families seek youth programming and resources.

The Bullitt County Public Library operates 5 branches across the county and offers recurring youth and family programming, including LEGO Club, Pokémon Club, and family-centered events.⁴

The Bullitt County Health Department publishes an online resource guide that connects residents with local services, including a section dedicated to educational resources.⁵ Together, these existing community touchpoints demonstrate that Bullitt County families already have established channels for accessing youth programming and information about local support services.

Recommendations

LEN should continue investing recruitment resources in Bullitt County, but should shift its strategy away from online advertisements towards targeted referral-based recruitment through schools and other established community institutions until more is known about the factors contributing to high attrition among families reached through online ads.

1. Prioritize school-based referral partnerships.

LEN should adapt its successful parent referral and school-based recruitment strategies for Bullitt County. LEN should prioritize partnerships with FRCs and YSCs, whose connections with students and families may help LEN reach students whose needs align with its mission.

LEN should also engage classroom teachers who can identify students who may benefit from academic support and refer their families to LEN. Potential strategies include distributing referral information to faculty through FRC/YSC coordinators and briefly presenting LEN's services during faculty professional development meetings.

Finally, LEN should pursue opportunities for in-person recruitment at Bullitt County school events, including back-to-school and open house nights. These events may provide a Bullitt County counterpart to the school-based outreach that performed well in Jefferson County.

2. Expand library-based outreach at programs specifically serving tweens and families.

The Bullitt County library table had the highest parent-contact-to-match conversion rate of the three Bullitt County recruitment channels. However, the dataset captures only one library event, making additional testing necessary before drawing broader conclusions about the effectiveness of library-based outreach. LEN should expand library-based recruitment across Bullitt County's five library branches and track outcomes by branch and event type. Tabling efforts could be strategically timed alongside programs designated for families and tweens, such as Family Bingo at the Nichols Branch or LEGO Club at the Central Library.⁴ This approach would allow LEN to more intentionally reach families with children near its target grade range while generating additional data on the effectiveness of library-based recruitment.

3. Increase LEN's presence within existing community resource networks.

LEN should increase its visibility within existing Bullitt County community resource networks. As an immediate, low-cost step, LEN should request inclusion as an educational resource in the Bullitt County Health Department's online Resource Guide.⁵

LEN should also explore referral partnerships with community organizations that serve families across different areas of Bullitt County, including food pantries and resource centers. These organizations operate in multiple communities throughout the county and may provide additional geographic touchpoints beyond schools and the county's 5 library branches.⁶ Rather than relying primarily on in-person recruitment events, LEN could equip community partners with concise program information and referral materials to share with families who may benefit from academic support.

Limitations and Additional Data Requirements

While this analysis provides directional guidance, several data gaps limit the precision of the conclusions. These limitations do not invalidate the observed patterns, but additional data would strengthen

confidence in the recommendations and support more informed recruitment planning.

1. The significant drop-off between parent contact and application among families reached through Bullitt County online ads warrants further analysis. Additional data on contact type, ad messaging, audience targeting, and reasons for non-completion could help determine whether the campaign generated low-intent contacts or whether barriers within LEN's follow-up and application process contributed to attrition.
2. The geographic scope and referral sources associated with the Parent referral campaign are unclear. Additional data identifying whether referrals originated in Jefferson County, Bullitt County, or both would improve county-level comparisons. Understanding who initiated each referral—such as parents, teachers, school staff, or community partners—would also help LEN identify which referral relationships are driving the campaign's strong performance.
3. The definition of “average follow-up days” is unclear. If the metric reflects LEN response time, additional analysis could examine whether delayed follow-up is associated with lower funnel retention.
4. Recruitment channel and geography are not directly comparable across counties. Jefferson County and Bullitt County were reached through different combinations of recruitment methods, making it difficult to determine whether differences in outcomes are driven by geography, recruitment strategy, or both. Testing similar recruitment methods in both counties would allow for stronger county-level comparisons.
5. The “parent contact” metric combines sign-up sheets, QR scans, and form starts, which may represent different levels of initial interest or intent. Additional data separating parent contacts by contact type would help determine whether differences in funnel conversion are partially influenced by how initial engagement is measured across channels.

Appendix

1. **Bullitt County Public Schools.** [District information and Kentucky Summative Assessment Results.](#)
2. **Census Reporter.** [Bullitt County, Kentucky Commute Data.](#)
3. **Bullitt County Public Schools.** [Family Resource Center and Youth Services Center Contact Directory.](#)
4. **Bullitt County Public Library.** [Tween and Family Events Calendar.](#)
5. **Bullitt County Health Department.** [Community Resource Guide.](#)
6. **Bullitt County Public Schools.** [Bullitt County Food Pantry Locations.](#)